

Study in China

Cost of Living Guide for Students in China (2026)

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Cost of Living Guide for Students in China (2026)

Understanding the cost of living is essential for planning your studies in China. Here's a detailed breakdown by city tier.

Tier 1 Cities (Beijing, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Shenzhen)

* University dormitory: ¥600-1,500/month

* Shared apartment: ¥2,000-4,000/month per room

* Meals (campus canteen): ¥15-30/day

* Meals (off-campus): ¥40-80/day

* Metro/Bus: ¥200-400/month

* Mobile phone plan: ¥50-100/month

* Total monthly budget: ¥3,000-6,000

Tier 2 Cities (Chengdu, Hangzhou, Wuhan, Xi'an, Nanjing)

* University dormitory: ¥500-1,200/month

* Shared apartment: ¥1,200-2,500/month per room

* Meals (campus canteen): ¥10-25/day

* Meals (off-campus): ¥30-60/day

* Metro/Bus: ¥100-300/month

* Mobile phone plan: ¥30-80/month

* Total monthly budget: ¥2,000-4,500

Money-Saving Tips:

* Always eat at campus canteens -- subsidized and nutritious

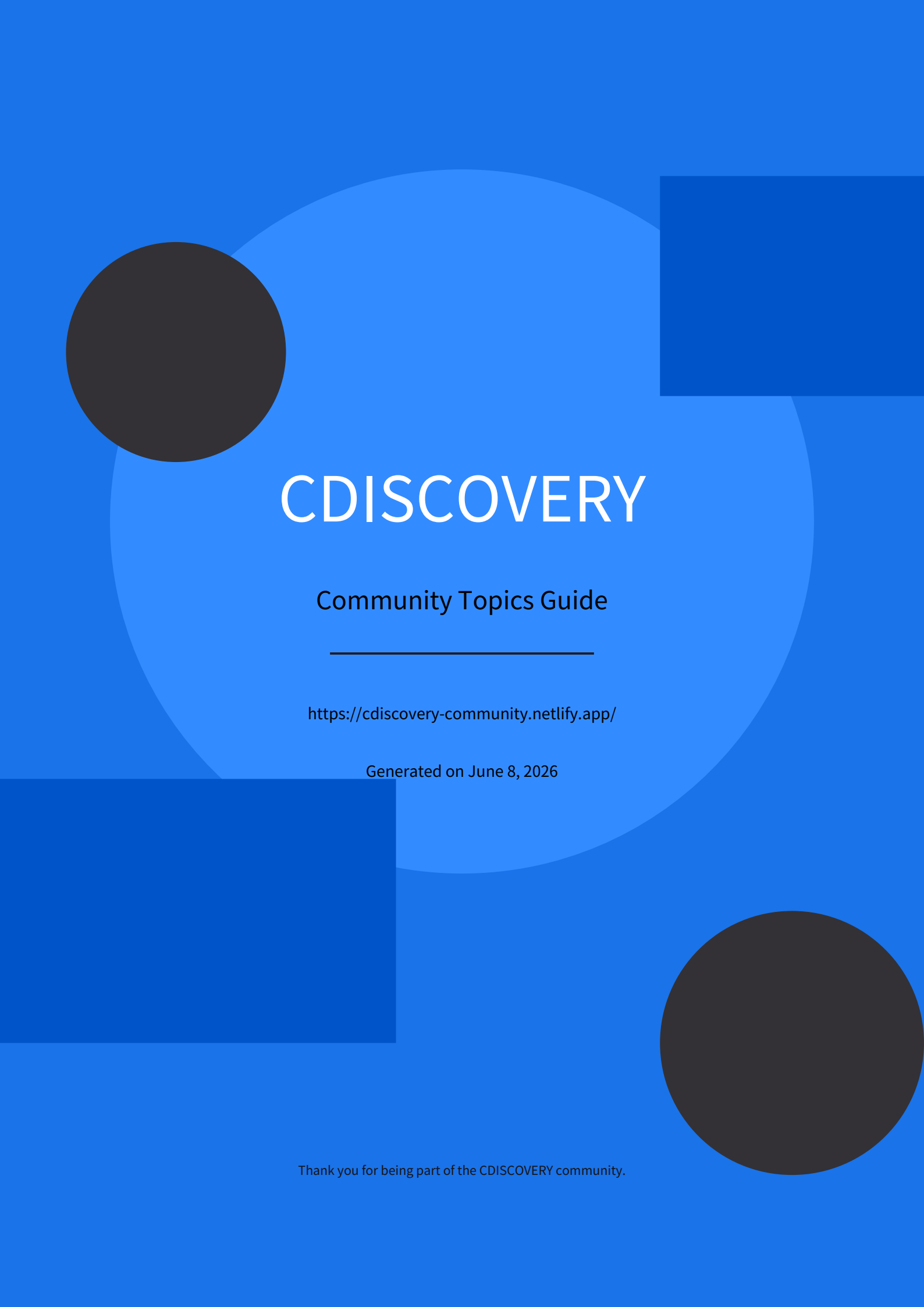
* Use student discounts on metro cards (50% off in many cities)

* Shop at local wet markets for groceries (30-50% cheaper than supermarkets)

* Use Taobao/Pinduoduo for online shopping deals

* Apply for university merit scholarships (¥3,000-10,000/year)

Sources: Sources: [Numbeo Cost of Living Index](https://www.numbeo.com) • [Ministry of Education](http://www.moe.gov.cn)

The background is a solid blue color. In the center, there is a large, light blue circle. To the left of this circle is a dark grey circle. To the right is a dark blue rectangle. Below the light blue circle is a dark blue rectangle. In the bottom right corner is a dark grey circle. The text "CDISCOVERY" is written in white, bold, sans-serif font across the center of the light blue circle.

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